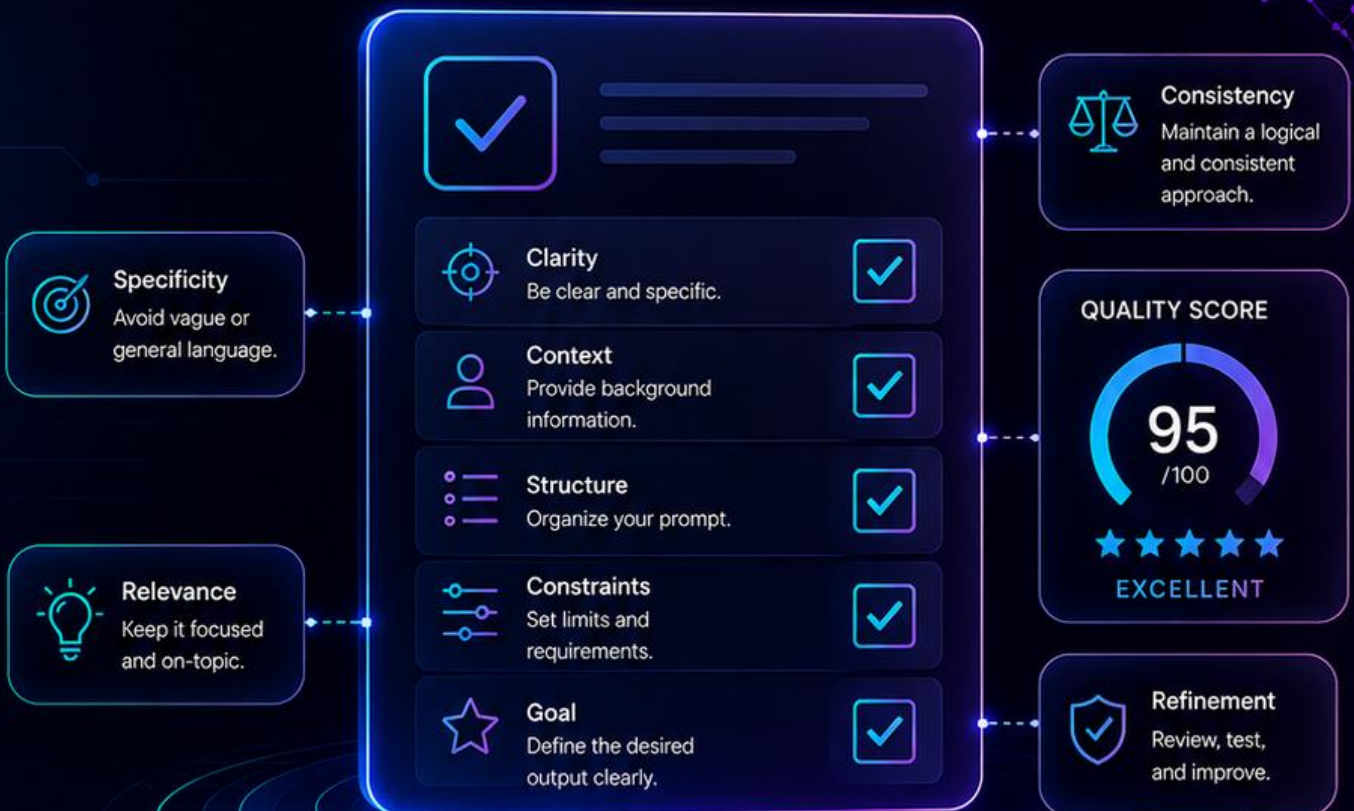




Aicadmia

THE PROMPT QUALITY CHECKLIST

WRITE HIGH-QUALITY PROMPTS.
GET BETTER AI RESULTS.



Higher Quality
AI Outputs



Fewer Revisions
& Iterations



Save Time
& Effort



Better Results
Every Time

LEARN SMARTER | WORK FASTER

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

How to Use This Checklist

This is your complete quality control system for AI prompts. Use it before you send any important prompt, after you get a weak response, or whenever you want to level up your prompting skills. The better your prompts — the better your AI results. Every time.

SECTION 1 — The 10-Point Master Checklist

Run every prompt through these 10 questions before sending.

SECTION 2 — The Prompt Scoring System

Score your prompt out of 100 to measure its strength.

SECTION 3 — Checklists by Use Case

Specific checklists for writing, business, research, and more.

SECTION 4 — The Weak Prompt Diagnostic

Identify exactly why your prompt failed and how to fix it.

SECTION 5 — Prompt Upgrade Templates

Before and after examples that show the transformation.

SECTION 6 — The Prompt Refinement System

A step-by-step process to improve any prompt in minutes.

SECTION 7 — Quick Reference Cards

One-page checklists to keep open while you work.

SECTION 8 — Master Prompt Templates

Fully built templates for every situation — ready to use.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A great prompt is not written — it is refined.
This checklist turns your first draft into a prompt that actually works.

Anatomy of a Perfect Prompt

Before you can check the quality of a prompt, you need to know what a perfect prompt looks like. Every great prompt contains these six ingredients — in any order, at any length.

ROLE	TASK	CONTEXT	FORMAT	TONE	CONSTRAINTS
ROLE — Who is the AI? Tell AI what expert to act as. Why it matters: AI with a role gives more specific, credible, and useful answers. Without it: AI gives generic responses that could apply to anyone. Example: "Act as a senior marketing copywriter with 10 years of B2B experience."					
TASK — What should AI do? Tell AI exactly what action to take. Why it matters: a vague task creates a vague output. Without it: AI guesses what you want and usually guesses wrong. Example: "Write a 200-word cold email subject line + body for a SaaS product launch."					
CONTEXT — What is the situation? Give AI the background it needs. Why it matters: context lets AI tailor every word to your situation. Without it: AI invents assumptions — often wrong ones. Example: "My audience is HR managers at companies with 50-500 employees. They care about retention."					
FORMAT — How should it look? Specify the output structure. Why it matters: the right format makes outputs immediately usable. Without it: AI defaults to paragraphs of text that you then have to reformat. Example: "Format as: Subject line / Opening hook / 3 bullet points / CTA / PS line."					
TONE — How should it sound? Define the voice and style. Why it matters: tone mismatches make even great content feel wrong. Without it: AI guesses — and often defaults to corporate or bland language. Example: "Tone: professional but conversational. No jargon. Direct and warm."					
CONSTRAINTS — What to avoid? Set limits on what AI should not do. Why it matters: constraints eliminate the most common output failures. Without it: AI pads, hedges, repeats itself, or goes off-topic. Example: "Under 200 words. No bullet lists. Do not mention competitors. Avoid clichés."					

The 10-Point Master Prompt Checklist

Run every important prompt through all 10 of these checks before sending. The more you tick, the better your output will be.

☐ **1. Is the goal crystal clear?**

Can you state in one sentence exactly what you want from this prompt? If not, refine it.

☐ **2. Did I give AI a role?**

Does your prompt start with "Act as a..." or define a specific expert persona for AI to embody?

☐ **3. Did I provide enough context?**

Does AI know who this is for, what the situation is, and what background matters?

☐ **4. Is the task specific enough?**

Could 10 people read this prompt and all produce the same type of output? That is specific.

☐ **5. Did I specify the format?**

Does the prompt say: email / bullet list / table / script / numbered steps / paragraph / etc.?

☐ **6. Did I define the tone?**

Does AI know: professional / casual / persuasive / educational / friendly / technical / simple?

☐ **7. Did I set constraints?**

Did I say what to avoid: length limits, no jargon, no fluff, no repeating myself, etc.?

☐ **8. Did I define the target audience?**

Does AI know who will read or receive this output? Audience shapes everything.

☐ **9. Is the prompt one focused task?**

Have you split multi-part requests into separate prompts for better results on each?

☐ **10. Am I ready to refine it?**

Do you have a follow-up plan if the output needs improving? (Hint: you almost always will.)

KEY TAKEAWAY

10 out of 10 is rare — and that is fine.

7 or more is a strong prompt. Under 5 means it needs significant work before sending.

The Prompt Scoring System

Score your prompt across 10 dimensions. Each dimension is worth 10 points — giving a maximum score of 100. Use this to identify exactly which parts of your prompt need the most work.

1. Clarity — Is the goal completely clear?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
2. Role — Does AI have a clear expert persona?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
3. Context — Is enough background information provided?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
4. Specificity — Are the details precise and actionable?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
5. Format — Is the output structure specified?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
6. Tone — Is the voice/style defined?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
7. Audience — Is the target reader defined?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
8. Constraints — Are limits and avoidances stated?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
9. Focus — Is this a single, clear task?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10
10. Completeness — Does AI have everything it needs?	☐ Yes ☐ No	/10

How to Interpret Your Score

90-100 — EXCELLENT

Your prompt is well-structured, specific, and complete. Send it with confidence.
Expected output: targeted, high-quality, immediately usable.

70-89 — GOOD

Strong prompt with minor gaps. Review your lowest-scoring dimensions and add one more detail.
Expected output: useful but may need one refinement cycle.

50-69 — AVERAGE

Several dimensions are missing. Rewrite before sending — you will save time overall.
Expected output: generic or partially useful — requires significant editing.

Below 50 — WEAK

Major dimensions missing. This prompt will produce a generic, unusable response.
Action: start over using the Master Template on the final page.

Writing & Content Prompt Checklist

Use this specific checklist whenever you are using AI to write, edit, or create any type of content — emails, articles, social posts, scripts, proposals, and more.

☐ **Did I specify the content type?**

Email / blog post / social caption / script / proposal / report / newsletter

☐ **Did I set the exact length?**

Number of words, paragraphs, or sections — not just "short" or "long."

☐ **Did I define the target audience?**

Who will read this? Their role, level of expertise, and what they care about.

☐ **Did I set the tone and voice?**

Formal / casual / persuasive / educational / empathetic / confident.

☐ **Did I specify the goal of the content?**

Inform / persuade / entertain / sell / engage / educate / convert.

☐ **Did I include a structure or format?**

Hook + body + CTA? Heading + subpoints? Intro + 3 arguments + conclusion?

☐ **Did I say what NOT to include?**

No jargon / no clichés / no passive voice / no filler / no competitor names.

☐ **Did I give relevant background?**

What is the product, service, brand, or situation this content is about?

☐ **Did I request examples or evidence?**

Do I want statistics, examples, or anecdotes to be included?

☐ **Did I ask for multiple versions?**

Did I ask for 2-3 variations so I can choose the best one?

STRONG WRITING PROMPT EXAMPLE

Act as an experienced B2B copywriter.

Write a 120-word cold email to HR managers at mid-size tech companies.

Offer: employee wellness platform. Pain point: burnout and retention.

Tone: professional but warm. Format: subject line + 3 short paragraphs + CTA.

Avoid: buzzwords, exclamation marks, and generic openers like "I hope this finds you well."

Research & Analysis Prompt Checklist

Use this checklist whenever you are asking AI to research a topic, analyze data or arguments, summarize information, or produce insights.

☐ **Did I define the exact topic and scope?**

What specifically are you researching? Be precise — not "AI" but "AI in healthcare hiring."

☐ **Did I specify the depth of analysis needed?**

Surface overview / deep analysis / executive summary / academic depth.

☐ **Did I define the target audience for this research?**

Who will read the analysis? Their expertise level shapes the language.

☐ **Did I specify what sources or perspective to use?**

Academic / business / news / expert opinion / historical / current (2024-2026).

☐ **Did I ask AI to flag uncertainty or gaps?**

"If you are unsure about any fact, say so clearly and suggest where I can verify it."

☐ **Did I ask for a structured format?**

Overview + key findings + evidence + implications + sources (if available).

☐ **Did I ask for actionable insights, not just facts?**

"Based on this research, what should I do / be aware of / consider?"

☐ **Did I define the timeframe I am interested in?**

"Focus on developments from 2023-2026" or "focus on historical context."

☐ **Did I ask for comparisons where relevant?**

"Compare this to [X]" or "contrast with the previous approach."

☐ **Did I ask AI to identify what it does NOT know?**

"Tell me where your knowledge might be limited or outdated on this topic."

KEY TAKEAWAY

Research prompts fail most often because they are too broad.
The tighter the scope, the more useful the analysis.

Business & Professional Prompt Checklist

Use this checklist for all business prompts — emails, proposals, reports, strategies, plans, HR documents, meeting summaries, and professional communications.

☐ **Did I define the business context?**

Industry / company type / size / stage / target market — AI needs this to be useful.

☐ **Did I specify who the recipient or audience is?**

Client / CEO / potential investor / team member / customer — each needs a different approach.

☐ **Did I set the professional tone?**

Formal / executive / consultative / persuasive / collaborative / clear and direct.

☐ **Did I define the business goal of this output?**

Close a deal / get approval / communicate a decision / inspire action / solve a problem.

☐ **Did I specify any industry standards or requirements?**

Legal disclaimers needed? Specific terminology? Regulatory or compliance context?

☐ **Did I give the full context needed?**

Meeting notes to summarize? Past email thread? Product details? Company background?

☐ **Did I set a professional format?**

Executive summary / proposal sections / email structure / report headings / table.

☐ **Did I specify what NOT to include?**

No opinions / no recommendations beyond scope / no pricing without approval / no jargon.

☐ **Did I give a length or word count?**

"Under 200 words" / "2 paragraphs" / "one A4 page" / "3 bullet points per section."

☐ **Did I check for confidentiality before sharing context?**

Anonymized client names? No sensitive financial data? No unreleased product details?

Creative & Storytelling Prompt Checklist

Use this checklist for creative prompts — stories, scripts, character descriptions, campaign concepts, brand narratives, and creative copy.

☐ **Did I describe the genre and style?**

Thriller / comedy / professional narrative / minimalist / lyrical / punchy and bold.

☐ **Did I describe the characters or voice?**

Who is the narrator? What are the characters like? What is the brand voice?

☐ **Did I set the mood or emotion?**

Inspirational / urgent / funny / nostalgic / tense / warm / bold / thought-provoking.

☐ **Did I specify the setting or context?**

Where does this take place? What world or scenario is this set in?

☐ **Did I define the audience?**

Who is this for? Their age, interests, knowledge level, and what they need to feel.

☐ **Did I give a clear structure?**

Beginning / middle / end? Hook + conflict + resolution? 3 acts? Specific scene list?

☐ **Did I mention any references or inspirations?**

"In the style of [X]" or "similar tone to [brand / author / show]."

☐ **Did I define what I do NOT want?**

No clichés / no overly dramatic language / no predictable endings / no stereotypes.

☐ **Did I specify the length and format?**

Word count / number of scenes / number of lines / number of slides or sections.

☐ **Did I ask for multiple creative options?**

"Give me 3 different directions / concepts / openings so I can choose the best one."

STRONG CREATIVE PROMPT EXAMPLE

Act as a brand storyteller specializing in purpose-driven brands.
Write a 200-word brand story for a sustainable clothing company.
Target audience: eco-conscious millennials aged 25-35.
Tone: warm, authentic, inspiring — not preachy or corporate.
Structure: founder moment + the problem they saw + the brand mission + a vision statement.
Avoid: clichés like "change the world" or "one step at a time."

The Weak Prompt Diagnostic

When AI gives you a bad response, the problem is almost always the prompt — not the AI. Use this diagnostic to identify exactly what went wrong and how to fix it.

SYMPTOM: Answer is too generic

DIAGNOSIS: Your prompt had no role, no audience, and no specific context.

FIX: Add "Act as a [EXPERT]. This is for [SPECIFIC AUDIENCE] in the context of [SITUATION]."

EXAMPLE FIX: Not "explain social media marketing" but "explain social media marketing to a solo florist starting their first Instagram account."

SYMPTOM: Answer is too long

DIAGNOSIS: You did not set a length constraint.

FIX: Add "Keep your response under [X] words" or "Respond in [X] bullet points maximum."

EXAMPLE FIX: Add "Under 150 words. 3 bullet points. One sentence per point."

SYMPTOM: Answer is too short

DIAGNOSIS: Your task was too vague — AI did the minimum version of what you asked.

FIX: Be explicit: "Provide a comprehensive, detailed answer. Include examples. Cover at least [X] points."

EXAMPLE FIX: "Give me a complete, detailed breakdown of [X] — aim for 400-500 words."

SYMPTOM: Answer is off-topic

DIAGNOSIS: AI misunderstood the task because it was ambiguous.

FIX: Rewrite your task line to be more explicit. Start with a precise action verb.

EXAMPLE FIX: Not "help me with my email" but "rewrite this email to be more concise and persuasive — keep all key points but cut 40% of the length."

SYMPTOM: Answer sounds robotic

DIAGNOSIS: You did not specify tone. AI defaulted to formal, neutral language.

FIX: Add a detailed tone description and an example of the voice you want.

EXAMPLE FIX: "Tone: warm and direct. Like a knowledgeable friend — not a textbook. Short sentences. Active voice. No corporate speak."

SYMPTOM: Answer is full of fluff

DIAGNOSIS: No constraints were set on what to avoid.

FIX: Add explicit negative constraints: "No filler. No preamble. No summaries at the end. Every sentence must add value."

EXAMPLE FIX: "Do not start with pleasantries. Skip the summary at the end. No padding. Get to the point immediately."

Before & After Prompt Transformations

See exactly what changes when you apply the checklist. Same request — completely different quality of output.

✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Write me a marketing email.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a senior B2B copywriter. Write a cold email for a SaaS project management tool targeting operations managers at companies with 100-500 employees, Pain: too many tools, no visibility. Goal: book a 15-minute demo. Tone: professional and direct. Format: subject line + 3 short paragraphs + CTA. Under 150 words. No buzzwords.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, audience, pain point, goal, format, constraints.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 92/100 — role, audience, pain, goal, format, tone, constraints all present.
✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Explain how to grow on social media.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a social media growth strategist. Explain the 5 most effective tactics for growing an Instagram account for a personal finance educator targeting 22-35 year olds. Focus on organic growth in 2026. For each tactic: what it is, why it works, and one specific action I can take today. Format: numbered list with subpoints.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, niche, audience, format, specificity of advice.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 90/100 — platform, niche, age, tactics, format, actions all specified.
✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Help me write a proposal.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a senior consultant. Write a project proposal for a 3-month brand redesign for a B2B SaaS client in the legal tech industry. Sections: executive summary, problem statement, proposed approach (3 phases), deliverables, timeline, and investment summary. Tone: professional and confident. Format: bold section headers, bullet points for lists. Under 600 words total.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, client type, sections, format, word count.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 94/100 — role, client, industry, sections, format, tone, word count all present.

More Before & After Transformations

Three more transformations — for research, creative writing, and study use cases.

✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Research the future of AI.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a technology analyst. Summarize the 5 most significant trends in AI for business leaders in 2026. For each trend: what it is, the evidence for it, the business impact, and one actionable implication. Target reader: non-technical C-suite executive. Format: numbered list, under 50 words per trend. Cite the type of source (academic/industry) for each point.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, specificity, audience, format, depth required.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 91/100 — analyst role, specific trends, audience, format, word limit, sourcing all present.
✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Write me a story about an entrepreneur.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a business journalist writing for Fast Company. Write a 300-word first-person narrative told by a first-generation immigrant entrepreneur who launched a tech startup in 2024 with no funding. Open with a specific moment of doubt. End with the insight that changed everything. Tone: raw, honest, inspiring — not motivational fluff. No clichés.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, perspective, word count, structure, tone definition, constraints.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 93/100 — journalist voice, character, word count, structure, tone, anti-cliché all specified.
✗ WEAK PROMPT ✗ Explain machine learning.	✓ STRONG PROMPT ✓ Act as a university computer science professor teaching introductory AI. Explain machine learning to a second-year student who understands statistics but has never coded ML. Use an everyday analogy first, then the technical definition, then walk through supervised learning with a real-world example. End with 3 exam-style questions. Avoid advanced jargon without defining it.
WHY IT IS WEAK Missing: role, student level, structure, analogy requirement, constraints on language.	WHY IT WORKS Score: 95/100 — professor role, exact student level, structure, analogy, example, quiz, constraints all present.

The 5-Step Prompt Refinement System

The best prompts are not written in one go. They are refined. This 5-step system turns any weak prompt into a strong one in under 5 minutes.

STEP 1 — Write your first draft prompt

Write whatever comes naturally. Do not worry about quality yet.
Just get your request down in one or two sentences.
Example: "Write a LinkedIn post about leadership."

STEP 2 — Run the 10-point checklist

Go through every point of the Master Checklist on page 4.
Mark each point: Yes / No / Partially.
Note which dimensions score lowest — those are your priorities.

STEP 3 — Add the missing dimensions

For every "No" on the checklist, add the missing element.
Role missing? Add "Act as a [ROLE]."
Audience missing? Add "The target audience is [AUDIENCE]."
Format missing? Add "Format as [FORMAT]."

STEP 4 — Add two negative constraints

The two most powerful words in prompting are "Do NOT."
Always add at least two things you do not want in the output.
Examples: "Do not use clichés." / "Do not exceed 150 words." / "Do not include opinions."

STEP 5 — Score it, then send it

Run your refined prompt through the scoring system (page 5).
If it scores below 70: make one more pass through the checklist.
If it scores 70 or above: send it. Then plan your refinement follow-up.

KEY TAKEAWAY

You will rarely write a 90+ prompt on your first try.
That is not failure — that is the process. Refinement is the skill.

Follow-Up Refinement Prompt Library

After your first response, use these follow-up prompts to improve, adjust, and perfect the output. Never accept the first draft as final.

When the output is close but not quite right:

F01 Make this more [specific / concise / persuasive / professional / clear / engaging].

F02 Rewrite this but make it shorter. Cut 30% without losing any key information.

F03 The tone is too [formal / casual / salesy / technical]. Adjust the tone and rewrite.

F04 Rewrite the opening. Make the first sentence impossible to ignore.

F05 Remove all filler sentences. Every line should earn its place. Rewrite.

When the output missed the point:

F06 That was not what I meant. Let me clarify: [ADD CLEARER EXPLANATION]. Now try again.

F07 You answered too broadly. Focus only on [SPECIFIC ASPECT] and go deeper.

F08 Ignore the previous response. Here is a better version of my request: [REWRITE]

F09 The format was wrong. Rewrite the same content but as a [NEW FORMAT].

F10 You missed the most important part: [WHAT WAS MISSING]. Incorporate this and redo it.

When you want to go further:

F11 Give me 3 alternative versions of this with different tones / angles / approaches.

F12 Now make this 2x stronger. More specific examples, tighter language, stronger argument.

F13 Play devil's advocate. What is the strongest argument against what you just wrote?

F14 Now adapt this for [DIFFERENT AUDIENCE / PLATFORM / CONTEXT].

F15 What is the one change that would make this 50% more effective? Make that change.

Coding Prompt Checklist

Use this checklist whenever you ask AI to write, debug, explain, review, or refactor code. Good coding prompts get clean, working code on the first try.

☐ Did I specify the programming language and version?

Python 3.11 / JavaScript ES2024 / TypeScript / React 18 / SQL (PostgreSQL).

☐ Did I describe what the code should do — exactly?

Input + expected output + edge cases to handle.

☐ Did I explain the context of the codebase?

What framework, library, or existing code does this need to work with?

☐ Did I specify the coding style or standards?

Clean code / commented / specific naming conventions / no external libraries.

☐ Did I ask for error handling?

"Include error handling for [edge cases]. Handle [X] gracefully."

☐ Did I ask for an explanation alongside the code?

"After the code, explain what each function does and why you made those choices."

☐ Did I paste the existing code when relevant?

For debugging or refactoring: always share the current code with the error message.

☐ Did I specify what I do NOT want?

No external dependencies / no deprecated methods / no hardcoded values.

☐ Did I ask for tests?

"Include unit tests for [key functions]."

☐ Did I ask for a step-by-step explanation?

"Walk me through what this code does line by line" for learning or review.

STRONG CODING PROMPT EXAMPLE

Act as a senior Python developer.
Write a function that takes a CSV file path as input and returns a pandas DataFrame with: duplicates removed, column names cleaned (lowercase, underscores), and missing values filled with 0 for numeric columns and "Unknown" for strings.
Python 3.11. Include type hints, docstring, and error handling for missing files.
No external libraries beyond pandas. After the code, explain each step.

Advanced Role Design Checklist

The role you give AI is one of the most powerful elements of any prompt. A well-designed role transforms generic responses into expert-level output. Use this checklist to build better AI roles.

☐ Is the role specific and relevant to the task?

"Senior B2B copywriter" beats "writer." "Pediatric nurse" beats "healthcare professional."

☐ Does the role have relevant experience or expertise?

"...with 10 years of experience in [field]" adds depth and specificity to the persona.

☐ Does the role match the audience?

A "Harvard professor" voice for a 10-year-old audience is a mismatch. Calibrate the role.

☐ Is the role being asked to do something in its expertise?

Do not ask a copywriter to debug code. Match role capabilities to the task.

☐ Did you give the role a point of view or perspective?

"Act as a skeptical investor" vs "Act as a supporter" give opposite outputs from the same prompt.

☐ Did you add personality or communication style to the role?

"...who explains things in plain English" or "...known for blunt, no-fluff advice."

☐ Can you make the role more specific to your industry?

"Act as a CFO at a Series B SaaS startup" beats "Act as a financial professional."

☐ Did you consider role stacking for complex tasks?

"Act as both a data analyst and a storyteller" can produce richer, more balanced outputs.

Role Examples — Weak vs Strong

Weak: "a writer"	Strong: "an award-winning long-form journalist specializing in climate technology who writes for a non-technical audience."
Weak: "a business expert"	Strong: "a McKinsey-trained strategy consultant who has worked with Fortune 500 retail brands on digital transformation."
Weak: "a teacher"	Strong: "a patient high school chemistry teacher known for using everyday analogies and visual thinking to explain difficult concepts."
Weak: "a developer"	Strong: "a senior full-stack engineer with 8 years building enterprise SaaS applications using React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL."

The Constraint Checklist

Constraints are the most underused element of prompt engineering. They eliminate the most common output failures before they happen. Use this checklist to set the right constraints every time.

Length Constraints

L1 Set a maximum word count: "Under [X] words" — not "keep it short."

L2 Set a structure constraint: "In exactly [X] bullet points / paragraphs / sections."

L3 Set a depth constraint: "Cover [X] key points in depth — not a surface overview."

Style Constraints

S1 Language level: "Use simple language a 14-year-old could understand" or "technical depth."

S2 Voice: "Active voice only. No passive constructions."

S3 Vocabulary: "No jargon / no acronyms without definition / no buzzwords."

S4 Punctuation: "Short sentences. No semicolons. No em-dashes."

Content Constraints

C1 "Do not include opinions — stick to evidence and facts."

C2 "Do not repeat points across sections. Each section must add something new."

C3 "Do not use filler phrases like 'certainly', 'great question', 'as an AI'."

C4 "Do not include a summary at the end — end with the last main point."

C5 "Do not recommend [competitor name] or any specific brand names."

C6 "Do not start with the word 'I', 'The', or any form of preamble."

The Format Checklist

Format shapes how useful the output is. The same content in the wrong format is often unusable. Use this checklist to specify format precisely every time.

Choosing the Right Format

Use BULLET POINTS when:

You want scannable, modular information.

Best for: feature lists, tips, comparisons, step-by-step instructions, pros and cons.

Add to prompt: "Format as [X] bullet points. Each bullet: one sentence max."

Use a TABLE when:

You are comparing multiple items across multiple dimensions.

Best for: competitor analysis, feature comparison, schedules, decision matrices.

Add to prompt: "Format as a table with columns: [COL1] / [COL2] / [COL3]."

Use NUMBERED STEPS when:

The order matters and each step builds on the last.

Best for: tutorials, processes, how-to guides, workflows, instructions.

Add to prompt: "Format as numbered steps. One action per step."

Use PARAGRAPHS when:

You need flowing, connected reasoning or narrative.

Best for: essays, analyses, reports, explanations, storytelling.

Add to prompt: "Format as [X] paragraphs. Max [X] sentences each."

Use a SCRIPT / DIALOGUE when:

You need conversational or spoken content.

Best for: podcast scripts, sales calls, interview prep, video narration.

Add to prompt: "Format as a script with speaker labels: HOST: / GUEST:"

Use SECTIONS WITH HEADERS when:

The content has distinct parts that need to be navigable.

Best for: reports, proposals, guides, briefs, strategy documents.

Add to prompt: "Format with bold section headers. [X] sections: [LIST THEM]."

Quick Reference Card — Pre-Send Checklist

Print or bookmark this page. Run through it before sending any important prompt.

THE 10-POINT PRE-SEND CHECKLIST

- ☐ Is my goal completely clear?
- ☐ Did I give AI a specific role?
- ☐ Did I provide relevant context?
- ☐ Is the task specific and actionable?
- ☐ Did I specify the output format?
- ☐ Did I define the tone and voice?
- ☐ Did I name the target audience?
- ☐ Did I add at least 2 constraints?
- ☐ Is this one focused task (not five)?
- ☐ Does AI have everything it needs?

THE 6-ELEMENT FORMULA

ROLE	TASK	CONTEXT	FORMAT	TONE	CONSTRAINTS
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PROMPT SCORE GUIDE

- 90-100

★★★★★

Send with confidence
- 70-89

★★★★☆

Add one more detail
- 50-69

★★★☆☆

Rewrite before sending
- 0-49

★★☆☆☆

Start over with the formula

TOP 5 CONSTRAINTS TO ADD

- ☐ Word / length limit
- ☐ No filler or fluff
- ☐ Format specified
- ☐ No jargon / define all acronyms
- ☐ No summary / no preamble

Quick Reference Card — Refinement Phrases

Use these phrases to refine any AI response instantly. Paste the phrase after any output to improve it.

Make It Better

B01 Make this more specific. Add concrete examples and data.

B02 Rewrite this to be 30% shorter without losing any key points.

B03 The tone is off. Rewrite with a [professional / casual / direct] tone.

B04 Make the opening stronger. Start with the most compelling point.

B05 Remove all generic statements. Every sentence must be specific and actionable.

Change the Format

BF1 Convert this to a numbered step-by-step list.

BF2 Put this into a comparison table with columns: [COL1] / [COL2] / [COL3].

BF3 Reformat as bullet points. Max one sentence per bullet.

BF4 Reorganize this into sections with bold headers: [LIST YOUR SECTIONS].

Go Deeper

BD1 Expand on point [X]. Give me 200 more words on that specific topic.

BD2 Add 3 real-world examples that prove the main point.

BD3 What is the strongest counterargument to this? Address it.

BD4 Now take this from good to exceptional. What would make it significantly stronger?

Fix Problems

FX1 Start over. Here is a clearer version of what I need: [REWRITE YOUR REQUEST].

FX2 You missed the point. The most important thing I needed was [X]. Focus on that.

FX3 Ignore the previous answer. Try a completely different approach to this.

Prompt Checklist by Goal

Different goals require different prompt priorities. Use the right checklist for your specific objective.

GOAL: PERSUADE SOMEONE

- ☐ Did I identify what the person currently believes or objects to?
- ☐ Did I frame the benefit from their perspective, not mine?
- ☐ Did I ask for emotional as well as logical appeal?
- ☐ Did I ask AI to anticipate and address objections?
- ☐ Did I specify a clear call to action at the end?
- ☐ Did I set a confident, not pushy, tone?

GOAL: EXPLAIN A COMPLEX IDEA

- ☐ Did I specify the audience's current level of knowledge?
- ☐ Did I ask for an analogy before the technical explanation?
- ☐ Did I ask for real-world examples, not abstract descriptions?
- ☐ Did I ask AI to define any technical terms it uses?
- ☐ Did I ask for a simple summary at the end?
- ☐ Did I say what NOT to assume about the audience?

GOAL: CREATE A PLAN OR STRATEGY

- ☐ Did I define the starting point and the desired end state?
- ☐ Did I specify the time frame and available resources?
- ☐ Did I ask for prioritized actions, not just a list of ideas?
- ☐ Did I ask AI to identify potential obstacles?
- ☐ Did I request a format with milestones and owners?
- ☐ Did I ask for metrics or success criteria?

GOAL: GET FEEDBACK OR REVIEW

- ☐ Did I share the actual content to be reviewed?
- ☐ Did I tell AI what level of criticism I can handle?
- ☐ Did I specify what I want feedback ON (structure / tone / logic / accuracy)?
- ☐ Did I ask for specific suggestions, not just problems identified?
- ☐ Did I ask for an overall rating or score?
- ☐ Did I ask "what is the one thing that would improve this the most?"

GOAL: BRAINSTORM IDEAS

- ☐ Did I define the problem or opportunity clearly?
- ☐ Did I specify the number of ideas I want?
- ☐ Did I ask for ideas at different scales (quick wins vs big bets)?
- ☐ Did I say what types of ideas to avoid?
- ☐ Did I give AI context on what has already been tried?
- ☐ Did I ask for one sentence of rationale for each idea?

The 10 Most Common Prompt Mistakes

Use this as a final check before sending. If you catch any of these in your prompt — fix them first.

MISTAKE 1: Vague task verb

Replace "help me with" with a precise action: write / rewrite / analyze / create / summarize / fix.

MISTAKE 2: No role specified

Always add "Act as a [SPECIFIC ROLE]." It is the single highest-ROI change you can make to any prompt.

MISTAKE 3: Audience assumed

Never assume AI knows who will read the output. State it explicitly every time.

MISTAKE 4: Too many tasks in one

If you want 5 things — send 5 prompts. Multi-task prompts produce mediocre results on all 5.

MISTAKE 5: Format not specified

AI defaults to paragraphs. If you want a table, list, or email — say so. Always.

MISTAKE 6: No length guidance

"Short" means nothing. "Under 150 words" means everything. Always be specific about length.

MISTAKE 7: No constraints added

Constraints prevent the most common output failures. Add at least 2 "Do NOT" statements.

MISTAKE 8: Accepting the first output

The first response is never the final answer. Always follow up with at least one refinement.

MISTAKE 9: Trusting facts without checking

AI can sound confident while being wrong. Verify any specific claim with Perplexity or a primary source.

MISTAKE 10: No context given

Context is what makes a generic answer become a useful, tailored one. Share what AI needs to know.

Advanced Prompting Technique Checklist

Once you have mastered the basics, use these advanced techniques to push prompt quality to the next level.

CHAIN OF THOUGHT

Add: "Think through this step by step before giving your final answer."

Best for: complex reasoning, multi-step analysis, strategy, and decision-making.

Result: More considered, better-reasoned responses with visible logic.

PERSPECTIVE STACKING

Add: "Act as both [ROLE A] and [ROLE B]. Give me both perspectives."

Best for: decisions, reviews, balanced analysis, and creative challenges.

Result: Richer, more nuanced outputs that surface hidden tensions.

QUESTION FIRST

Add: "Before you answer, ask me up to 5 questions that will improve your response."

Best for: complex, personalized, or context-heavy tasks.

Result: AI gathers what it needs — then produces a far better answer.

PERSONA TESTING

Add: "Now act as a skeptical [TARGET PERSON] reading this. What would they object to?"

Best for: sales copy, proposals, presentations, arguments.

Result: You find and fix weaknesses before your real audience does.

ITERATIVE BUILDING

Break complex outputs into stages: outline → draft → refine → polish.

Best for: long-form content, strategies, plans, complex documents.

Result: Each stage is reviewed and corrected before the next begins.

CONSTRAINT ESCALATION

Start with a good prompt. Then add one more constraint each round.

Best for: copy, headlines, names, slogans, tight creative deliverables.

Result: Progressively better outputs as constraints sharpen focus.

EXAMPLE PRIMING

Add: "Here is an example of the style and quality I want: [PASTE EXAMPLE]."

Best for: matching tone, style, or format to something specific.

Result: AI calibrates to your actual taste rather than a generic interpretation.

SELF-CRITIQUE LOOP

Add: "After writing your response, critique it. What are its weaknesses? Now fix them."

Best for: writing, analysis, code reviews.

Result: AI catches its own mistakes before you do.

Master Prompt Templates

These are fully built, high-scoring prompt templates for the most common situations. Copy, fill in the brackets, and send.

MASTER WRITING TEMPLATE

Act as a [CONTENT TYPE] specialist with experience in [INDUSTRY/NICHE].
Write a [FORMAT: email / post / article / script] about [TOPIC].
Target audience: [WHO WILL READ THIS].
Goal: [INFORM / PERSUADE / ENTERTAIN / CONVERT].
Tone: [PROFESSIONAL / CASUAL / PERSUASIVE / EDUCATIONAL].
Length: under [X] words.
Format: [STRUCTURE: bullet points / paragraphs / sections].
Include: [SPECIFIC ELEMENTS TO INCLUDE].
Do NOT: [WHAT TO AVOID].

MASTER RESEARCH TEMPLATE

Act as a [ANALYST TYPE] with expertise in [FIELD].
Research and summarize [TOPIC] for [AUDIENCE].
Include: overview, [X] key findings, evidence for each, implications.
Timeframe: focus on [YEAR RANGE].
Format: sections with bold headers, bullet points for key data.
Depth: [OVERVIEW / DEEP-DIVE / EXECUTIVE SUMMARY].
If you are unsure about any fact — say so clearly.
Under [X] words total.

MASTER BUSINESS TEMPLATE

Act as a [BUSINESS ROLE: consultant / strategist / copywriter].
[TASK: write / analyze / create / plan] for [CLIENT/COMPANY TYPE].
Business context: [INDUSTRY, STAGE, SIZE, KEY GOAL].
Audience: [WHO WILL RECEIVE THIS].
Format: [FORMAT].
Tone: [TONE].
Must include: [REQUIRED ELEMENTS].
Must NOT include: [EXCLUSIONS].
Length: [WORD COUNT / PAGES].

MASTER ANALYSIS TEMPLATE

Act as a [ANALYTICAL ROLE].
Analyze [SUBJECT/SITUATION/DATA].
Framework to use: [SWOT / pros-cons / risk assessment / comparison].
Consider: [KEY DIMENSIONS TO ANALYZE].
Audience: [WHO WILL USE THIS ANALYSIS].
Be objective — present evidence for each point.
If data is limited, say so and suggest what information would help.
Format: [FORMAT]. Length: [LENGTH].

The Prompt Quality Master Reference

Everything you need on one page. Bookmark it. Keep it open while you work.

THE UNIVERSAL MASTER PROMPT TEMPLATE

Act as a [SPECIFIC ROLE with experience/specialty].
Your task is to [PRECISE ACTION VERB + DELIVERABLE].
Context: [SITUATION, BACKGROUND, WHAT AI NEEDS TO KNOW].
Audience: [WHO WILL READ / USE THIS OUTPUT].
Format: [EXACT STRUCTURE OF THE OUTPUT].
Tone: [HOW IT SHOULD SOUND].
Include: [REQUIRED ELEMENTS].
Do NOT: [AT LEAST 2 THINGS TO AVOID].
Length: [WORD COUNT OR STRUCTURE LIMIT].

The 10-Point Master Checklist — Fast Version

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Goal clear? | ☐ Role specified? |
| ☐ Context provided? | ☐ Task specific? |
| ☐ Format defined? | ☐ Tone set? |
| ☐ Audience named? | ☐ Constraints added? |
| ☐ One task only? | ☐ Complete? |

Top 10 Refinement Phrases

R01 Make this more specific. Remove all generic statements.

R02 Rewrite this 30% shorter. Keep every key point.

R03 The tone is wrong. Adjust to [TONE] and rewrite.

R04 Give me 3 alternative versions with different approaches.

R05 Remove filler. Every sentence must add real value.

R06 Add 2-3 specific, real-world examples to support the main point.

R07 Reformat this as [NEW FORMAT].

R08 What is the one change that would make this significantly better? Make it.

R09 Critique your own answer. What are its weaknesses? Now fix them.

R10 Ignore the last response. Here is a clearer request: [REWRITE].

A great prompt is not written — it is refined. Score it. Fix it. Send it.

Master AI Prompts. Learn Smarter. Work Faster. — Aicadmia